the location where you intend to install the radiator. Since radiators are involved, you need to consider the thickness and length of the radiator to understand whether it's compatible with your chassis.

Open-loop liquid coolers will additionally require extra space to accommodate the liquid reservoir and pump in the case. You'll be dealing with tubes here, so you need to match the size of the tubes and the fittings. There are different measurement specifications including inner diameter (ID), outer diameter (OD) and wall thickness. When you're buying fittings, you need to check for the thread size whether it's compatible with the tube diameters. All these points are to be considered only when you're buying the parts individually, otherwise, all the components in a custom cooling kit will be compatible with each other.

Warranty cover: Air coolers will last you way longer than liquid coolers. The only moving part is the fan which can be easily replaced later. However, liquid coolers have several moving parts which means more points of failure. These include the pump, tubing and radiator. At some point, the pump will stop working and it can't really be replaced by the user. Tubing will fail once the insides start wearing out which might lead to leakage later. In this case, warranty coverage in liquid coolers should be of priority. You also need to verify the components which are covered under warranty.

What not to consider

Cosmetic tubing: For aesthetic purposes, the tubing on closed-loop liquid coolers are decorated with bright colours and sleeving. Although sleeving does make the tube slightly stiffer than plain rubber tubing, what matters is the contact points and the internal layer of the tube. The contact points include the pump and the radiator where wear and tear will result in leaks.

Coolant colour: Colour is added to the coolant only to make it 'look' cooler, not literally so. The colour of your coolant won't serve any purpose apart from

Some fancy coolants can really gunk up your system.